# Mariana Meireles

## AI Safety Researcher

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**SUSSEX CENTRE FOR CONSCIOUSNESS SCIENCE** **Sussex, UK**

**Researcher** **Oct 2026 - Present**

- Researching the principles of intelligence with informational theoretical tools

**UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA BERKELEY** **Berkeley, California, US**

**Visiting Scholar at the Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence Lab (CHAI)** **Apr 2025 - Present**

- Developing a technical and philosophical framework for the future of the Web together with the Meaning Alignment Institute
- Working on a symbolic AI solution for browser-based agents that increases model robustness against prompt-injection, "Symbolic AI and Native Web Standards Solutions for Safe Agentic Browser". This project is a collaboration with Mozilla and supported by the Foresight Institute AI Safety Grant
- Second author on ICLR 2026 workshop paper "From the Wild Web to the Zoo: Benchmarking Web Agents with a Realistic Simulator" benchmarking LLM based agents in the web
- Helped to build Zoo, an isolated, reproducible multi-application web environment for security evaluation of LLM web agents, enabling backend ground-truth verification and deterministic resets
    - Paper "From the Wild Web to the Zoo: A Realistic Environment for Evaluating Web Agents" accepted at MADWEB 2026 workshop accompanying NDSS
- First author on NeurIPS 2025 workshop paper "The Influence of Scaffolds on Coordination Scaling Laws in LLM Agents," analyzing how role hierarchy, memory, theory of mind and task decomposition shape coordination performance in multi-agent LLM systems
- Applying information theory to MLP activations of LLMs (in progress) to identify neuron groups that encode information synergistically, quantifying how this synergy is organized across depth and model scale and how it shifts under emergent-misalignment fine-tuning; developed a spectral search that scales the measurement to whole networks (performance on my spectral method yields similar results to a far more computationally expensive and thorough search)

**COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE PROJECT** **San Francisco, California, US**

**Research Fellow** **Jul 2026 - Present**

- Developing methods to keep democratic deliberation legible at scale, on the premise that aggregation tools should surface disagreement rather than summarize it away. Specifically, I'm formalizing the shallow/structural consensus distinction using probabilistic dependency graphs, and benchmarking whether frontier LLMs preserve it when representing public views.

**COOPERATIVE AI FELLOWSHIP - UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO** **Cape Town, SA**

**Researcher at the Jinesis Lab** **Feb 2026 - May 2026**

- First author on "Toward collective intelligence: evolutionary pressures for cooperative language models" (accepted at NeurIPS 2026 - FAST Workshop). This work asks whether LLMs cooperate in a similar way to biological systems. It takes Nowak's five rules of cooperation as ground truth and borrows from neuroscience and physics, specifically coordination dynamics, to model and shape how LLMs behave toward each other in game theoretical scenarios. To train the model we use RLVR. After our fine-tuning LLMs become broadly more cooperative as attested by increase in performance various different benchmarks.

**MAX PLANCK INSTITUTE FOR EVOLUTIONARY BIOLOGY** **Remote, Plön, DE**

**Researcher Software Engineer** **May 2024 - Mar 2025**

- Building tools to understand underlying relationships through long evolutionary chains of microbiotics.
  - Poster: Leveraging the Power of Complex Logical Query Answering with Natural Language
- Developed a graph ontology database for biological systems by creating an unifying software to download various formats from different sources and unify them under RDF
  - Detection and Characterization of Evolutionary Patterns Through Graph Neural Networks
  - Integration of Bioimage and Omics Data Resources
- Participated in various events helping to create and promote FAIR standards to improve data sharing

**UNIVERSITY OF BONN** **Remote**

**Researcher at the Barfuss Lab** **Jan 2024 - Jun 2024**

- Exploring the nonlinear dynamics of cooperation among heterogeneous Reinforcement Learning agents
  - Modeling Cooperation in Heterogeneous Multi-Agent Systems
  - Poster presented at Max Planck Society 2024
- Added heterogeneous agent functionality to the open-source Python package on Collective Reinforcement Learning Dynamics (CRLD)

**IMPACT ACADEMY** **Remote, Bangalore, IN**

**Research Fellow** **Oct 2023 - Apr 2024**

- Research in Cooperative AI focusing on the interaction between superintelligent systems and humans
  - Advised by Anders Sandberg and Wolfram Barfuss
- Best research award in the Impact Academy's 2024 cohort

**ANACONDA** **Remote, Berlin, DE**

**Software Engineer III** **May 2022 - May 2023**

- Engineered and improved various aspects of PyScript's API, including the output system, core Python code re-architecture, WASM integration and Python multithreading in the browser, implemented the initial testing infrastructure and the CI system
- Led early efforts in community building for PyScript. Built bridges with external projects like JetBrains, Jupyter, Pyodide and other contributors
- Organized an international, cross-project group with 8 organizations and 20+ contributors to establish a centralized set of protocols for Python web development

**NASA** **Remote**

**Subject Matter Expert (Contract)** **Jun 2022 - Aug 2022**

- Presented the state of the art of the open science research ecosystem to the group of researchers
- Collaborated in building the chapter on the "Ethos of Open Science" for NASA's Open Science 101 EDx course

**QUANTSTACK** **Remote, Berlin, DE**

**Scientific Software Engineer** **Feb 2020 - Apr 2022**

- Integrated the Cytoscape interactive graph library into the Jupyter ecosystem as a widget. Developed Jupyter kernels to support major SQL languages and implemented data visualization capabilities for SQL query outputs within the notebook environment. Added a new visualization mode to Jupyter notebooks. Created a deprecation finder for Bloomberg software and contributed it to the Jupyter project
- Authored several aspects of the Mamba and Micromamba APIs and developed R bindings, resulting in a package manager system 25x faster than CRAN. Released and maintained several different packages in the conda-forge ecosystem

**MOZILLA** **Remote, Orlando, US**

**Web Performance Intern** **Dec 2018 - Feb 2019**

- Cut the average loading time of the Webcompat website by 35% through the implementation of server-side rendering, HTTP/2, enhanced compression algorithms, and the removal and reimplementation of libraries
- Employed Selenium-designed tests to track down some performance bottlenecks and decrease the page load time by 1s in low-speed mobile connections
- Submitted patches for Firefox

**Open Source Contributor** **Aug 2018 - Nov 2018**

- Contributed to Firefox's testing codebase
- Organized Rust events as well as translated part of The Rust Book and various workshop materials

## GRANTS & AWARDS

- Lightcone Commons Grantee **2026**
- BlueDot Fast Grants **2026**
- Future of Life Institute Grantee **2026 - 2027**
- Foresight Institute's AI Safety Grant **2025 - 2026**
- Cooperative AI Foundation Fellowship **2026**
- Impact Academy Award for best research project **2024**
- Jupyter Distinguished Contributor award **2022**

## INVITED TALKS, CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

- NeurIPS 2026 - Fast Workshop paper
- Poster accepted at Science of Consciousness Conference 2026
- Maths for AI Safety Workshop 2026
- Foresight Institute Secure & Sovereign AI Workshop 2026: Talk on hardening AI systems against prompt injection
- 7th International Conference on the Mathematics of Neuroscience and AI: Consequences of synergistic organisation in language models
- ICML 2026 Supercooperation: The Future of AI for Democracy Workshop
- ICLR 2026: From the Wild Web to the Zoo: Benchmarking Web Agents with a Realistic Simulator

- MADWEB 2026 (Workshop accompanying NDSS): From the Wild Web to the Zoo: A Realistic Environment for Evaluating Web Agents
- NeurIPS 2025 Scaling Environments for Agents Workshop: The Influence of Scaffolds on Coordination Scaling Laws in LLM Agents
- NeurIPS 2025 Multi-Turn Interactions in Large Language Models Workshop: The Influence of Scaffolds on Coordination Scaling Laws in LLM Agents
- CooperativeAI Summer School 2025: The Effects of Heterogeneity in LLM Cooperation
- Biohackathon Germany 2024: Increasing Interoperability of Bioimage Dataset Resources
- Max Planck Institute Carpentries 2024: Workshop: Research and Data Management 2024
- Knowledge Graph Summer School 2024: Poster: Leveraging the Power of Complex Logical Query Answering with Natural Language
- CooperativeAI Summer School 2024, Machine + Behavior 2024, ELLIS CoGenAI Summer School 2024: Poster: Learning to Cooperate With Intelligence Inequality: A Complexity Science Exploration
- Impact Academy Summit 2024: Talk: Understanding Machine and Human Cooperation
- PythonPizza Hamburg 2024: Talk: How to Build a Universe From Scratch
- WCC Summer School 2023: Workshop: Environments and Packaging
- WCC Summer School 2023: Workshop: Pytest + Github Actions: How to Set Up an Environment
- WCC Summer School 2023: Workshop: Python Packaging: How to Release Your Own Python Package in Pypi and Conda
- Women of Code Summer School 2023: Workshop: Thoughts on Software Engineering: Software Design and Architecture
- PyLadies Berlin 2023: Talk: Jupyter Internals: Jupyter's Implementation Details and How to Contribute
- Scipy 2022: Tutorial: Ipywidgets
- WCC Summer School 2022: Workshop: Introduction to Qt for Python
- WCC Summer School 2022: Tutorial: The Git Survival Guide: Basic to Advanced Git
- Scipy 2021: Tutorial: Ipywidgets
- PyCon Brasil 2021: Talk: As Luas de Jupyter
- WCC Summer School 2021: Tutorial: How to Build Your Academic Website Profile
- QtCon Brasil 2020: Talk: Uma Introdução a PySide
- JupyterCon 2020: Talk: Ipycytoscape: An Interactive Graph Library for Jupyter
- JupyterCon 2020: Talk: Xeus: Multiple Languages Within Jupyter
- JupyterCon 2020: Talk: Memestra: A Deprecation Warning Tool
- QtCon 2020: Talk: Leveraging DeepLearning with PySide
- Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais Summer School 2020: Tutorial: Guia de Sobrevivência Git

## OPEN SCIENCE COMMUNITY SERVICES

- **Max Planck Institute Open Science Ambassador** *(2023-2024)*: A community of researchers committed to promoting transparency, reproducibility and collaboration in science.
- **Open Knowledge Foundation Expert** *(2023 - Present)*: Offering workshops, delivering talks and mentoring people into the open movement.
- **Internet Society Member** *(2023 - Present)*: Brazilian Chapter, Rural Development Community and Affordable Internet Access SIG.
- **Women of Color Code Organizer** *(2021 - 2024)*: Software mentor and co-organizer. The project seeks to unite members of minoritized groups in educational institutions and industry settings. Here I have delivered several software and open science classes to graduate students of various backgrounds.

- **PyLadies Berlin Organizer** *(2018 - 2024)*: Organizer of PyLadies Berlin, facilitating workshops and talks. Organizer of the Machine Learning Group for 6 months in which I held weekly meetings to teach and learn ML.
- **DISC NumFOCUS Steering Council Member** *(2022 - 2024)*: Responsible for organizing the NumFOCUS Unconference 2023, updating the NumFOCUS DISCOVER Cookbook and developing integration programs aimed at enabling participation from individuals of underprivileged communities into the open science ecosystem.
- **Jupyter Widgets Committee Member** *(2022 - 2024)*: Community maintenance and governance stewardship.

## LECTURES

- **NASA** *(2023)*: Open science EDx class
- **Guest Lecturer by the LSSTC-DSFP at Harvard** *(2022)*: Instructed graduate students in Astronomy on topics such as Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), performance optimization for scientific software, as well as open science and reproducible research practices.

## MENTORSHIP

- **Open Life Science Mentor** *(2023)*: Mentored undergraduate computer scientist in the development of a program designed to integrate young research software engineers into the field. This project was then integrated with the UK-RSE organization.

## ACADEMIC SERVICES

- US-RSE 2024 Reviewer
- NeurIPS 2024, 2025, 2026 Reviewer
- ICLR 2026 Reviewer
- ICML 2026 Reviewer

## EDUCATION

**UNIVERSITY OF SUSSEX** — **Brighton, UK**
***Masters in Artificial Life and Consciousness*** — **Sep 2026 - Sep 2027**

**MACHINE LEARNING FOR GOOD** — **Gnevkow, DE**
Topics covered: mechanistic interpretability, AI governance, Reinforcement Learning — **Sep 2024 - Oct 2024**

**CAMBRIDGE AI SAFETY HUB** — **Cambridge, UK**
***Cambridge Machine Learning for Alignment Bootcamp*** — **Apr 2024 - Apr 2024**
Topics covered: einops, CNNs, ResNets, Variational Autoencoders, Transformers from Scratch, Mechanistic Interpretability, Reinforcement Learning and RLHF

**SANTA FE INSTITUTE** — **Remote**
***Santa Fe Institute - Complexity Interactive*** — **Oct 2023 - Nov 2023**
Short abstract: How Does Polarization and Inequality Scale with Spatial and Population Size

**RECURSE CENTER** — **New York City, US**
Complex systems and LLM ABM software projects — **Jun 2023 - Sep 2023**

**UNIVERSIDADE FEDERAL DE MINAS GERAIS** — **Belo Horizonte, BR**
***Bachelor of Engineering, Major in Electrical Engineering; Minor in Computer Science*** *(Incomplete)* — **2015 - 2018**

## VOLUNTARY WORK

- **DoeBem Researcher** (2023): Contributed research to DoeBem, a Brazil-focused charity evaluator modeled on GiveWell; co-authored an analysis identifying priority needs of food-insecure communities in one of Brazil's poorest regions
- **Women in Engineering & CS** (Co-organizer, 2018–2024): PyLadies Berlin and Women of Color Code.
- **Engenharia Solidária** (University volunteer group, 2015–2017): Coordinated food and clothing donation drives, organized visits to nursing homes and orphanages, and helped build STEM outreach programs encouraging girls to pursue technical careers
- **Sétima Armada Board Game Club** (Co-organizer, 2012–2014): Co-organized Brazil's largest board game club; hosted events in favela cultural centers, partnering with educators to teach kids patience, collaboration, and strategic thinking through games